of the city. Babur was also trying to gather idea about which part he needed to march further to fulfil his imperialistic desires.

He got several suggestions. Few advised marching to Dasht, while some advised for Bangash. A party insisted on Hindustan. Babur chose the third option given his inclination for reconquering the Hindustan like Timur had desired.

It was the month of Sha'bān in AH 910 (January of AD 1505). Babur has mentioned that the sun was in Aquarius when he rode out of Kābul for Hindustan.

Babur along with his men took the road by Bādām-chashma (current Surobi district of Kābul) and Jagdālīk. He reached Adīnapūr (current Jalalabad) in six marches. The high temperature shocked Babur. He had neither witnessed such a hot climate nor the land bordering Hindustan till before then. It was a new world to him when he reached Nangarhār. The grasses, trees, animals and birds —everything was different. In Babur's own words, 'We were amazed, and truly there was ground for amazement.'

Babur met his half-brother Nāṣir Mīrzā there. He was waiting for Babur after his tourney to another district. Babur's campaign was delayed in Adīnapūr as he waited for the other men to join. He also waited for the contingent of a clan that had joined him from Kābul and had been wintering in the Lamghānāt.

The marching resumed after everybody joined. They dismounted next at Qūsh-guṃbaz below Jūī-shāhī. After having reached there, Nāṣir Mīrzā requested to leave to stay behind. He committed that he would follow in a few days after providing for his dependents and followers.

They eventually resumed the march. From Qūsh-guṃbaz, they dismounted at a hot spring (*garm-chashma*). Then a headman of the Gāgīānī was brought in with his caravan to guide on the way forward, which he did without any hesitation. They were able to cross Khyber in a couple of marches and dismounted at Jām-rūd (Jām torrent).

The headman recounted several tales while travelling with Babur, who has mentioned:[*]

> Gūr-khattrī was said to be a holy place of the Jogīs and Hindūs who come from long distances to shave their heads and beards there.

Babur had never come across Hindus before, and it looked an exciting sight to him at once.

Babur rode out from Jām to Bīgrām. He saw its great tree and all the country round, but, much as he enquired about Gūr-khattrī, his guide, Malik Bū-sa'īd